Mr. Holland’s Opus | Student Worksheet

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Directions: Write brief answers. Use character choices and scene evidence for analysis.

Before viewing

1. How might achievement include effects on others as well as a personal product?

During viewing

2. Why does Holland initially accept the teaching job?

3. What makes his first teaching approach difficult for students?

4. How does connecting lessons with familiar music change participation?

5. How does work begin to affect his composing goal?

6. What changes when the family learns Cole is deaf?

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During viewing

7. How does Iris respond to Cole’s communication needs?

8. How does a former student’s wartime death affect the school community?

9. Why does Holland’s interaction with Rowena require boundaries?

10. Why do former students organize the final concert?

After viewing

11. Choose a teaching change that responds to a learner’s needs.

12. Why is Holland’s legacy broader than completing a symphony?

13. What perspective could expand or challenge the film’s portrayal of deafness?

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